

Amanullah Wakman, PhD

International Relations | Foreign Policy | Afghanistan Studies

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Amanullah Wakman is a PhD graduate in International Relations from Tarbiat Modares University, Tehran, Iran. His research focuses on foreign policy analysis, neighbourhood policy, regional politics, regional security, international political economy, peace and conflict, political stability and instability, soft power, governance, and International Relations theory, with particular emphasis on Afghanistan and its relations with neighbouring and regional powers.

His research examines the logic of change and continuity in foreign and neighbourhood policies and develops multidimensional analytical approaches to understanding political, security, economic, social, ideational, and environmental dynamics.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- The Logic of Change and Continuity in Afghanistan's Neighbourhood Policy toward Iran
- The Logic of Change and Continuity in Ukraine's Neighbourhood Policy toward Russia
- The Taliban-U.S. Peace Agreement from the Perspective of Bargaining Game Theory
- The Role of China and India in Afghanistan's Political Stability
- The Role of Pakistan's Soft Power in Afghanistan's Political Instability
- The Normative Approach and Its Application to Governance under the Islamic Emirate
- Grotius Theory and the Principles of the Westphalian Order
- Critical Review of Liberalism in International Relations
- China's Economic Strategy in the Governance of Karzai and Ashraf Ghani

EDUCATION

PhD in International Relations

Tarbiat Modares University, Tehran, Iran | 2021–2026

Master's Degree in International Relations

Khatam-al-Nabieen University, Kabul, Afghanistan | 2018–2020

Bachelor's Degree in Jurisprudence and Law

Takhar University, Takhar, Afghanistan | 2008–2012

DOCTORAL RESEARCH

The Logic of Change and Continuity in Afghanistan's Neighbourhood Policy toward Iran: A Comparative Study of the Republic Era and the Second Islamic Emirate Period

The doctoral research examines changes and continuities in Afghanistan's neighbourhood policy toward Iran across the Republican period and the Second Islamic Emirate period. The study develops a six-dimensional analytical framework covering political-diplomatic, security, economic-commercial, cultural-social, identity-ideological, and environmental-natural resource dimensions.

ANALYTICAL MODEL & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Developed a six-dimensional analytical model for comparative analysis of neighbourhood policy and regional politics. The framework examines change and continuity in states' neighbourhood policies across different political periods and regimes and is designed for comparative application to Afghanistan, Ukraine, and other regional cases.

ACADEMIC & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Expert of Parliamentary Affairs

Ministry of State for Parliamentary Affairs, Afghanistan | June 2019 – August 2021

Professional Communications Expert

Government of Afghanistan | December 2017 – June 2019

Deputy of Technical and Professional Education

Department of Education, Takhar Province, Ministry of Education, Afghanistan | March 2016 – December 2017

Deputy Director of Education

Department of Education, Takhar Province, Afghanistan | July 2013 – March 2016

Literacy Teacher & Rule of Law Trainer

Afghanistan National Police Command, Takhar Province (GIZ-supported programme) | 2010–2011

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS & ACADEMIC WORKS

- The Logic of Change and Continuity in Afghanistan's Neighbourhood Policy toward Iran: A Comparative Study of the Republic Era and the Second Islamic Emirate Period. Central Eurasia Studies, 2026. Published.
- An Analysis of the Peace Agreement between the Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan and the United States from the Perspective of Bargaining Game Theory. Central Eurasia Studies, 2026. Published.
- The Logic of Change and Continuity in Ukraine's Neighbourhood Policy toward Russia: A Comparative Study of the Presidencies of Leonid Kuchma, Petro Poroshenko, and Volodymyr Zelenskyy. Under Review.
- The Role of Grotius's Theory in the Outcomes of the Peace of Westphalia. Under Review.
- The Normative Approach and Its Application in the Governance of the Taliban's Islamic Emirate. Under Review.
- The Role of China and India in Afghanistan's Political Stability. Academic Work / Dissertation, 2020.
- The Role of Pakistan's Soft Power in Afghanistan's Political Instability. Power and Politics in International Relations Conference, 2022.
- Critical Review of Liberalism in International Relations. Conference on Critique of International Relations Theories, 2021.
- China's Economic Strategy in the Governance of Karzai and Ashraf Ghani. International Political Economy Conference, 2022.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY & ANALYTICAL FRAMEWORK

Research Approach: Qualitative explanatory-analytical research; comparative within-case analysis.

Research Methods: Qualitative content analysis; process tracing; discourse analysis.

Analytical Framework: Six-dimensional model covering political-diplomatic, security, economic-commercial, cultural-social, identity-ideological, and environmental-natural resource dimensions.

Theoretical Interests: Defensive Realism; Neoclassical Realism; Constructivism; Liberal Institutionalism; Neoliberal Institutionalism; International Relations Theory; Foreign Policy Analysis.

LANGUAGES

Dari: Native | Pashto: Fluent | English: Excellent | Arabic: Very Good | Turkish: Good

DIGITAL SKILLS

Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; Internet and online research tools; academic research and information retrieval; document management.

ONLINE ACADEMIC PROFILES

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Academic Website: <https://amanullahwakman.github.io/>

REFERENCES

Dr. Zaki Karimi

Former Professor & MA Supervisor, Khatam-al-Nabieen University

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Dr. Seyed Masoud Mousavi Shafaei

Associate Professor, Tarbiat Modares University

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Dr. Mohsen Eslami

Associate Professor & PhD Supervisor, Tarbiat Modares University

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Dr. Vali Golmohammadi

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